University of Ottawa: International Student Guide

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1. Welcome to uOttawa

The **University of Ottawa (uOttawa)** is a bilingual, research-intensive university located in the heart of Canada's capital. It attracts students from **over 145 countries**, offering education in English, French, or both. uOttawa emphasizes:

- High-quality academic programs
- Experiential learning opportunities
- Vibrant campus life
- Access to government, research, and industry

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2. Why Choose uOttawa?

- **Bilingual Education:** Courses available in English, French, or both
- **Location:** Study in the capital of Canada, with cultural and professional opportunities
- **Global Community:** Network with students from around the world
- **Research & Innovation:** Access to cutting-edge labs and research projects

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3. Programs and Academic Offerings

3.1 Undergraduate Studies

- Direct-entry programs available based on secondary education or equivalent
- Professional programs may require additional prerequisites or auditions
- Courses offered across faculties in Arts, Science, Engineering, Health Sciences, Music, Law, and Social Work

3.2 Experiential Learning

uOttawa emphasizes **hands-on learning**:

- Work-Study programs
- Internships and co-op placements
- Community engagement opportunities

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4. Application Overview for International Students

International students **must apply online** through the **Ontario Universities' Application Centre (OUAC)**. Key steps:

1. **Prepare to Apply**
    - Confirm eligibility based on previous education level
    - Verify program prerequisites and language requirements
    - Gather necessary documents (transcripts, diplomas, CV, portfolio, etc.)
2. **Get Admission Information Specific to You**
    - Select your country to receive tailored instructions
    - Special guidelines exist for students from IB, GCE, American High Schools, French lycée, or Canadian institutions
3. **Apply Online**
    - Complete your application on OUAC
    - Declare all current and previous postsecondary studies
    - Pay the application fees
    - Ensure your email is accurate to receive all notifications

⚠️ **Important Note:** uOttawa will not pre-assess applications. Admission is **only confirmed after all documents are submitted and evaluated**.

4. **Track Your Admission Status**
    - Receive acknowledgment within 1 week of applying
    - Use the **uoZone** portal to monitor progress
5. **Submit Required Documents**
    - Upload all documents via **uoDoc**
    - Documents not in English/French must be translated
    - Additional documents may be requested depending on program or academic background
    - Transcripts may need to be submitted to **World Education Services (WES)** for credential evaluation

6. **Understand Transfer Credits**
    - Transfer credits may be awarded for prior postsecondary study based on discipline and length of study
    - Minimum requirement: complete **50% of degree at uOttawa**
    - Examples of transfer credits:
        - **Advanced Placement (AP):** score ≥ 4 → up to 30 credits
        - **International Baccalaureate (IB):** grade ≥ 5 → credits based on program
        - **French Lycée:** grade ≥ 12/20 → up to 18 units
        - **GCE British Curriculum (A-levels):** grade ≥ B → credits depend on program

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5. Application Timeline (Undergraduate – Fall 2026 Intake)

Month	Key Dates & Actions
September – January 2025-2026	Application period opens **Sept 18, 2025** (OUAC); Recommended deadline: **Jan 15, 2026**. Prepare your admission file via uoZone.
March 2026	Deadline for competitive programs: **March 1, 2026** (submit supporting documents by **March 30**). Programs include: Acting, Computer Engineering, Computer Science, Data Science, Health Sciences, Music, Social Work, Software Engineering, Nursing, Visual Arts.
April 2026	Deadline for all other programs: **April 1, 2026**. Earliest acceptance date for offers: **April 1**. Recommended study permit application by this date.
May 2026	**May 2**: Submit all documents via uoDoc. Course enrollment begins. Pay non-refundable admission deposit.
June 2026	**June 1**: Accept offer and pay deposit. Receive Provincial Attestation Letter (PAL). Apply for housing and pay housing deposit. Prepare study permit documents.

Month	Key Dates & Actions
July – August 2026	Submit final grades and diploma. Participate in Work-Study program (optional). Attend online prep sessions. Pay tuition, ancillary, and housing fees.
Late August – Early September 2026	Orientation workshops for international students. Move into residence.
September 2026	Classes begin.

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6. Language Requirements

Students must demonstrate proficiency in **English or French** (depending on language of instruction).

Institution	Level	IELTS	TOEFL	Duolingo
University of Ottawa	Bachelor's	6.5	86	120
University of Ottawa	Master's	6.5	79	—
Algonquin College	Bachelor's	6.5	88	115
Carleton University	Bachelor's	6.5	86	—
Carleton University	Master's	6.5	86	—

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7. Tuition Fees (Approximate)

Institution	Bachelor's (International)	Master's (International)
University of Ottawa	42,000–65,000 CAD	20,000–56,000 CAD
Carleton University	37,000–69,300 CAD	19,800–46,400 CAD
Algonquin College	17,300–22,000 CAD	—

Other costs to consider:

- Accommodation
- Food
- Transport

- Personal expenses

Average total cost: **~32,100 CAD/year**

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8. Visa & Study Permit

International students require a **Canadian Study Permit**:

Required Documents:

- Valid passport
- Letter of acceptance from uOttawa
- Proof of financial capacity
- Passport photos
- Medical exam
- Letter of explanation

Steps to Apply:

1. Prepare all required documents
2. Apply online or at the nearest Visa Application Centre
3. Pay **150 CAD visa fee**
4. Attend biometrics or interview if required

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9. Admissions Events & Support

- Campus tours and online events for international students
- Virtual sessions to answer questions about programs and admissions
- Online resources for guidance, including FAQs and step-by-step videos

Contact Info:

InfoAdmission
Tabaret Hall, 75 Laurier Avenue East, Room 129
Ottawa, ON K1N 6N5, Canada
Phone: 613-562-5700
Email: admissions@uOttawa.ca

Virtual services: Book online appointments via uOttawa website

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10. Staying Connected

- Mailing list for updates on programs and events
- Social media: Facebook, Instagram, YouTube, TikTok
- Access helpful links for guidance counselors, fees, campus tours, and IT support

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11. Key Takeaways

1. Start planning **early**: research programs, check requirements, prepare documents
2. Apply **online via OUAC** and track your application in **uoZone**
3. Meet **all deadlines** for applications, document submissions, and tuition payments
4. Ensure **language proficiency** and prepare for any additional program-specific requirements
5. After acceptance: apply for study permit, housing, and prepare for orientation

Link : International applicants | Study